

TINY CUSTOM STORIES

Public Project Dossier

A detailed, public-facing account of the product direction, decisions, architecture principles, delivery approach, and unresolved questions.

Public reading note

This dossier is a curated public document, not a raw export of internal project files. It intentionally excludes credentials, private links, account or family information, personal data, operational security detail, provider configuration, and unpublished implementation material.

Version: September 2026

How to read this dossier

Tiny Custom Stories is being built in the open with boundaries. This document preserves the difference between what has been chosen, what is supported by repository evidence, what is still a proposal, and what remains unknown. A clear label is more useful than a polished claim that suggests more certainty than the project has earned.

Confirmed decision

An explicit direction adopted by the project founder or authorized decision maker. It can guide implementation, while its consequences and unresolved details remain visible.

Verified fact

A statement supported by current repository evidence or another named source. It describes evidence, not automatically an approved future direction.

Proposal, assumption, or open question

A possible direction, a temporary belief, or an unresolved matter. These labels are not delivery promises. The project keeps them visible so research, review, and testing can change the work.

1. Product purpose and audience

Tiny Custom Stories is intended to help children experience fun, personalized stories while giving parents control over the purpose and context of those stories. The starting point is not generic, passive content. It is a parent-led creative experience that aims to make room for imagination, conversation, and repeat reading.

- **Confirmed decision:** The core benefit is personalized learning through stories. Parents choose the lesson or purpose rather than the platform imposing one outcome.
- **Confirmed decision:** The first audience is children ages two through six. Parents are the primary operators; children are the beneficiaries and readers.
- **Confirmed decision:** The initial story purposes are morals and values, fun and fantasy, and reading development.
- **Confirmed decision:** Parents create stories and approve what children can access. Independent child access is limited to a parent-created or parent-approved library.
- **Open question:** Detailed reading levels, language support, accessibility needs, and the right role for children during creation still require evidence and testing.

2. First experience and creative boundaries

The Alpha direction is deliberately limited. A narrower experience makes it possible to learn from a coherent product rather than from an overextended feature list.

- **Confirmed decision:** The Alpha starts as a website. A future native application is not part of the first scope.
- **Confirmed decision:** A storybook has a separate cover followed by ten illustrated content pages. Narration and video are deferred.
- **Confirmed decision:** A guided form is the primary parent creation experience. It uses structured choices and short inputs rather than requiring prompt-engineering skill.
- **Confirmed decision:** A completely fictional story remains available without personal context.
- **Proposal:** A progressive, multi-section builder and a live story-plan summary may help parents understand the draft before generation. Exact fields and sequence are not yet approved.

3. Parent control, privacy, and child safety

Personalization can involve sensitive information. The public direction is clear about the intended boundary: parents control creation and approval, and family information is not public by default. The implementation and legal details remain work to be completed, not claims of compliance.

- **Confirmed decision:** A parent-managed Child Map is the default personalization source. Parents may choose fictional stories that do not use personal context.
- **Confirmed decision:** Parents may optionally provide reference photos to create reusable character representations. Parents approve characters before story use; generic or licensed-stock alternatives remain available.
- **Confirmed decision:** Customer information must not become public or directly accessible to other families without a separate future publishing choice.
- **Open question:** Minimum data fields, consent, retention, deletion execution, provider handling, access control, and child-specific legal obligations require qualified review.
- **Open question:** Content guardrails, unsafe-input handling, output reporting, and the full review/regeneration experience are not yet settled.

4. System architecture: the public view

The intended system is organized around focused responsibilities instead of one monolithic application or one all-purpose AI call. This is a logical architecture. It describes separable capabilities and responsibilities, not a final list of deployed services or a public operating manual.

Parent and child web experience -> API and authorization boundary -> workflow coordination -> focused story tools -> approved child library

At a high level, parents initiate and review a story; the platform coordinates the permitted steps; specialized capabilities produce or check bounded artifacts; and only approved material reaches the child-facing library.

Boundary	Public responsibility
Web experience	Parent creation, review, approvals, child library, and reader experience.
API and authorization	Account isolation, protected parent capabilities, validation, and application-owned access decisions.
Workflow coordination	Durable story state, permitted next steps, retries, budgets, and approval gates.
Focused tools	Child-context selection, text planning and drafting, quality checks, character and illustration work, and publishing.
Application data and media	Product-controlled artifacts and private media references. Detailed schemas and operational configuration are intentionally excluded.
Usage metering	Per-stage usage, cost, latency, retries, provider, and outcome evidence.

- **Confirmed architecture principle:** Tools exchange versioned, structured artifacts instead of whole chat histories.
- **Confirmed architecture principle:** A tool should receive only the context it needs for its task.
- **Confirmed architecture principle:** Deterministic validation, routing, storage, and publishing should not consume model tokens unnecessarily.
- **Proposal:** A durable .NET orchestrator and selected MCP-compatible tool adapters may support this separation. Exact technologies and deployment boundaries remain open.

5. Story lifecycle and quality approach

A proposed story workflow makes parent authority and recovery steps explicit. A workflow is not a single conversation with a model: it is product-controlled state with meaningful checkpoints.

- A parent chooses a purpose and supplies only the context they intend to use.
- A story plan and draft take shape through focused, bounded tools.
- Structural, reading, continuity, and content checks evaluate the work. The exact safety policy is still open.

- A parent reviews and can change, decline, or regenerate a draft before it is child-visible.
- Character and illustration work uses approved representations or a no-photo fallback.
- Publishing creates an approved storybook for the family library, not a public marketplace.

Important limitation

This lifecycle is a public description of intended responsibilities. It is not a claim that every check, provider integration, or review screen has already been built or validated.

6. Delivery model and roadmap

The founder and AI agents currently deliver the project through sequential, outcome-gated sprints. A sprint is complete when its outcome is demonstrated, not merely when a calendar period ends. The detailed operational board and issue tracking remain private.

Sprint	Public outcome gate
0 - Foundation	Documented constraints, proposed architecture, diagrams, Alpha scope, and clean React/.NET foundations.
1 - Accounts and parent mode	A parent can access protected adult capabilities while the child-facing experience remains distinct.
2 - Child Map and lifecycle	A parent can manage approved Child Map information and reference media with an explicit deletion path.
3 - Story vertical slice	A parent can generate, review, approve, and save a coherent ten-page text story.
4 - Characters and illustrations	A parent can approve character representations and produce consistent illustrations with a no-photo fallback.
5 - Child library and reader	Approved stories can become child-visible and be read page by page on a responsive website.
6 - Alpha readiness	Privacy, content safety, security, reliability, deployment, and acceptance evidence support a small private Alpha.

7. Decision record: public detail

The following condensed record preserves the project's accepted decisions without copying private discussion, links, or operational details. Dates are retained because they help readers distinguish the current direction from later revisions.

ID	Topic	Public record
DEC-001	Core benefit	Personalized learning through stories is the core benefit; parents choose the purpose.
DEC-002	Child Map	Parents manage reusable personalization context; fictional stories remain possible.
DEC-003	Three purposes	Start with morals and values, fun and fantasy, and reading development.
DEC-004	First audience	Design first for children ages two through six.
DEC-005	Parent-approved library	Independent child access is limited to approved family stories.
DEC-006	Website first	Start with a website and separate child and protected parent capabilities.
DEC-007	Story format	Use an unnumbered cover and ten illustrated content pages; narration/video are deferred.
DEC-008	Optional character photos	Parents may use and approve reference-photo-based character representations; no-photo fallback exists.
DEC-009	Private family data intent	Family information is not public by default; privacy implementation needs qualified review.
DEC-010	Target stack	Use React, TypeScript, Vite, ASP.NET Core, and .NET 10 for new work.
DEC-011	Outcome-gated delivery	Use sequential outcome gates rather than fixed-duration sprints.
DEC-012	Focused tools	Prefer focused, container-friendly capabilities over a monolith or one all-purpose AI context.
DEC-013	No relational SQL	The target architecture excludes relational SQL databases.
DEC-014	Guided builder	Use a guided form as the primary parent story-creation interface.
DEC-015	Versioned diagrams and decisions	Keep consequential architecture and experience decisions documented.
DEC-017 to DEC-019	Alpha platform choices	The project has selected an authentication direction and private document/media storage directions; detailed security, vendor, and operational configuration is not public.
DEC-020	Legacy frontend archive	The retired Angular frontend is preserved outside the default branch while the new target frontend is built separately.

8. Important open questions

The project intentionally keeps high-impact uncertainty visible. These questions are not defects in the document; they are commitments to avoid pretending that difficult matters have already been settled.

- What information should ever be collected in a Child Map, and what should never be collected?
- How should privacy, consent, retention, deletion, access, provider handling, and child safety be validated before Alpha use?
- How should a parent review, edit, regenerate, decline, or report AI-generated text and illustrations?
- What makes a story helpful across language, ability, reading level, and family context?
- Which requests and generated content must the platform prevent, and how should failures be handled?
- What evidence will demonstrate that the experience is valuable and safe enough to continue?
- Which remaining infrastructure, workflow, and provider choices best meet privacy, reliability, cost, and exit-path needs?

9. What this public document includes and excludes

This dossier draws from the project's product discovery, decision records, architecture overview, and Alpha roadmap. It presents detailed public context, but it is not a security assessment, privacy policy, legal statement, operating manual, or customer-data specification.

- **Included:** public product direction, labeled decisions and unknowns, logical architecture principles, a proposed workflow view, and outcome-gated roadmap intent.
- **Excluded:** credentials, secrets, private URLs, internal issue and board details, private research, personal information, family or child data, detailed threat analysis, exact data schemas, operational configurations, and unpublished code.
- **Maintenance:** material public changes should be reviewed by the founder, retain their knowledge-status labels, and be delivered through the public repository's protected pull-request workflow.

Source scope

Prepared from public-safe interpretations of the Tiny Custom Stories product discovery, decision log, architecture knowledge base, and Alpha roadmap as reviewed through September 2026. The internal source documents remain private and authoritative for internal work.